QBSearch (QuadBase Search)

A Highly Scalable, High-QPS Text Search Engine with Query-Optimization Middleware

Project Repository:
`https://github.com/Ashutosh-Ranjan09/QB_SEARCH`

Project Report

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1 Objective

The modern digital ecosystem demands search infrastructure capable of indexing rapidly growing datasets while servicing massive volumes of concurrent queries with sub-millisecond latencies. The primary objective of the QBSearch (QuadBase Search) project is to design, implement, and rigorously stress-test a highly scalable, keyword-based text search engine tailored for academic repositories and large document corpora.

Unlike traditional monolithic paradigms, this project constructs a highly decoupled architecture explicitly addressing system stability and latency under extreme read-heavy workloads. The core objectives are defined as follows:

- **High-QPS Operation:** Sustain high Requests-Per-Second (QPS) thresholds through distributed clustering, intelligent request routing, and transient in-memory caching mechanisms.
- **Overload Resilience:** Engineer a protective middleware layer to insulate the core search engine from deliberate denial-of-service (DDoS) requests or pathological queries.
- **Query Optimization:** Implement heuristic-based query reformulation leveraging dynamic weight assignments, phrase boosting, and typo tolerance to increase search precision rapidly.
- **Empirical Load Validation:** Develop a bespoke, multi-threaded C++ load-generation utility capable of simulating overwhelming network traffic to prove the efficacy of the implemented caching and networking layers.

2 Theoretical Background and Context

Search engines evaluate unstructured or semi-structured data using probabilistic models, distinguishing them fundamentally from standard relational database architectures.

- **Inverted Indexing (Lucene):** Rather than executing $O(N)$ string matching scans over datasets, Apache Solr relies on an inverted index. This structure maps distinct vocabulary terms back to the documents containing them, reducing retrieval latencies to near $O(1)$ disk reads.
- **Probabilistic Relevance (BM25):** To rank documents, modern systems deprecate linear TF-IDF models in favor of the Okapi BM25 algorithm. BM25 applies non-linear asymptotic saturation to term frequencies, preventing document hoarding of single keywords from falsely inflating relevance scores.
- **CAP Theorem Distribution:** Bound by the Consistency, Availability, and Partition Tolerance theorem, QBSearch actively sacrifices strict linear consistency. By rely-

ing on ZooKeeper for eventual synchronization, the system guarantees absolute component availability and partition tolerance.

3 Methodology

The methodology for constructing QBSearch involves a heavily layered, microservices-oriented architecture, communicating strictly via defined network protocols.

3.1 Distributed Search Backend: SolrCloud

At the core of the indexing pipeline lies Apache Solr, deployed in the highly available SolrCloud mode, orchestrated by a three-node Apache ZooKeeper ensemble. The `qb_collection` relies on dual principles:

- **Write Scalability (Sharding):** Datasets are partitioned logically across two shards, distributing the indexing memory overhead.
- **Read Scalability (Replication):** Two redundant replicas guarantee that identical read traffic can be serviced in parallel gracefully.

3.2 Containerization and Identity Management

The entire ecosystem adheres to Infrastructure as Code (IaC) principles.

- **Network Isolation:** Managed via a Docker bridge network (`qb_network`), securing internal administrative ports (e.g., ZooKeeper port 2181) from the host machine.
- **State Persistence:** Key index state logic and memory snapshots persist via explicitly mounted Docker volumes on the host system.
- **JWT Rotation:** Elevated administrative queries employ JSON Web Tokens (JWT) structured conceptually as stateless access tokens combined securely with database-coupled, revocable refresh hashes.

3.3 API Gateway: Query Optimization Engine

Before reaching the Solr Extended DisMax (eDisMax) parser, unformatted user queries pass through a Node.js filtering gateway that executes the following analytical transformations:

- **Categorical/Author Detection:** The API scans for CamelCase structures indicative of author names or standardized academic tags (e.g., *cs.AI*), dynamically boosting associated target fields by up to $8\times$.

- **Phrase Slop Constraints:** Imposing rigorous proximity restrictions on tokens mapped to the `title` and `abstract` fields to ensure adjacent contextual integrity.
- **Fuzzy Expansion:** Single-token queries automatically trigger Levenshtein distance calculations (approximating 1 or 2 threshold errors depending on word length) to securely handle typographical anomalies.

3.4 Tiered Caching and Security Topologies

To isolate the core backend from abusive computational cycles, the API incorporates rigorous front-line defenses:

- **Stateful Rate Limiting:** The middleware implements IP-based tracking, restricting users to exactly 100 requests per minute to neutralize algorithmic spamming algorithms.
- **Redis Hash Memory:** Unique query vectors (including pagination bounds and filters) are translated into cryptographic keys. Subsequent corresponding hits intercept the request completely, fetching results in sub-millisecond durations utilizing a rolling 60-second Time-to-Live (TTL) cache hierarchy.

3.5 Data Ingestion and Simulation Tools

Testing the boundaries of the developed platform necessitated explicit, highly specialized utility applications.

- **Asynchronous Batch Ingestion:** A Python script linearly unspools multi-gigabyte JSONL datasets in chunks of 500 documents exclusively to prevent Java Virtual Machine (JVM) buffer overflow and garbage collection freezes.
- **C++ Structural Load Generator:** A proprietary benchmarking application utilizes `std::thread` parallelism over a Mutex-locked queue. By mandating *HTTP Keep-Alive* persistence, the toolkit circumvents standard POSIX ephemeral port starvation mechanics, reliably drowning the server layers in artificial read-query matrices.

4 Results and Observations

Evaluation of the operational environment focused profoundly on contrasting metrics between an unprotected Solr core and the mitigated Node.js API boundary layer.

4.1 Implementation Visualizations

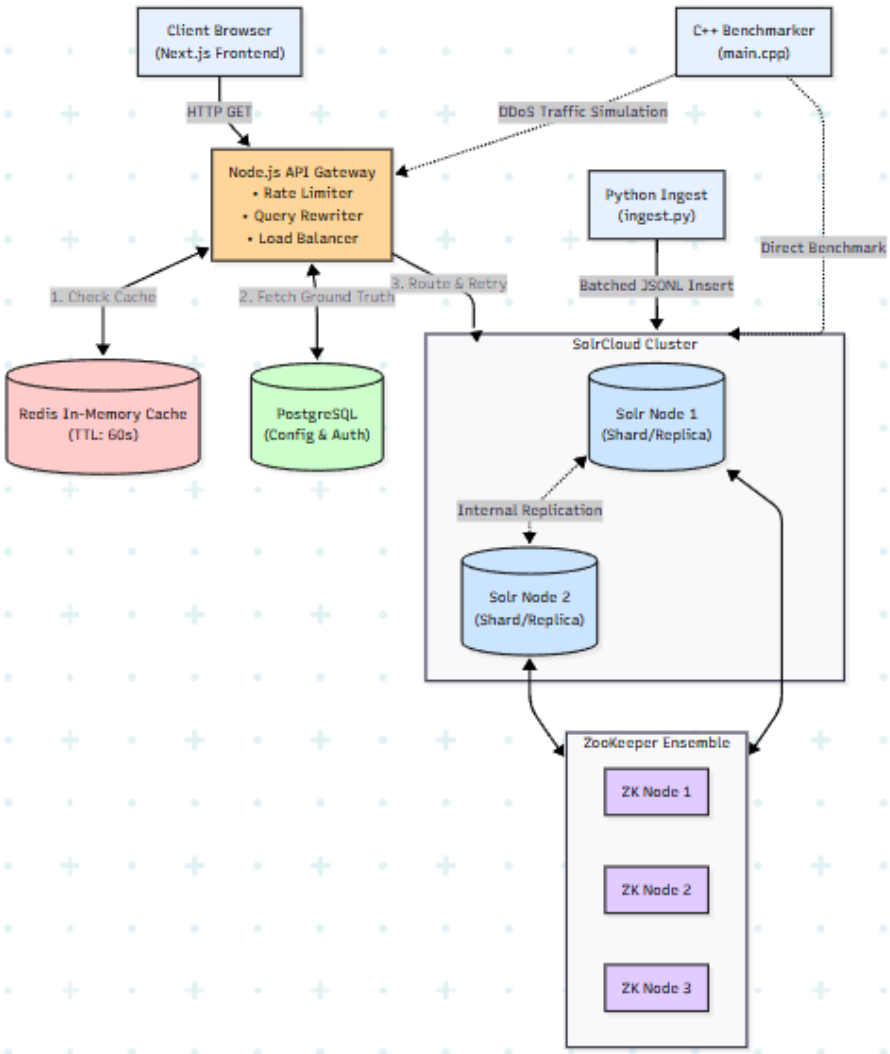


Figure 1: The high-level architecture diagram demonstrating the interaction pathways between the Next.js frontend, the multi-tiered Node.js API Gateway, Redis Cache, and the distributed SolrCloud environment.

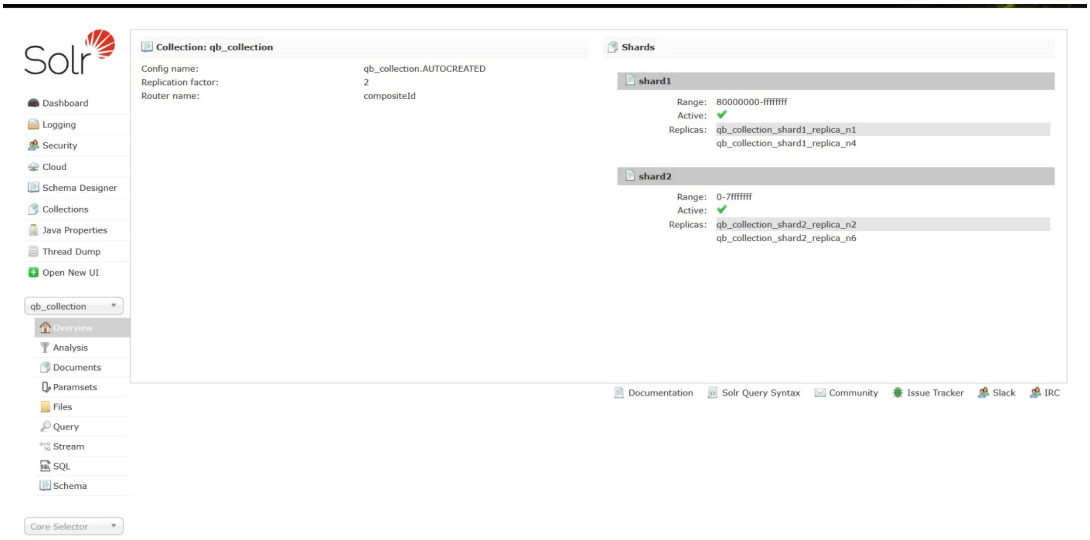


Figure 2: The Apache Solr administrative dashboard displaying the active nodes, ZooKeeper synchronization status, and `qb_collection` replicas.

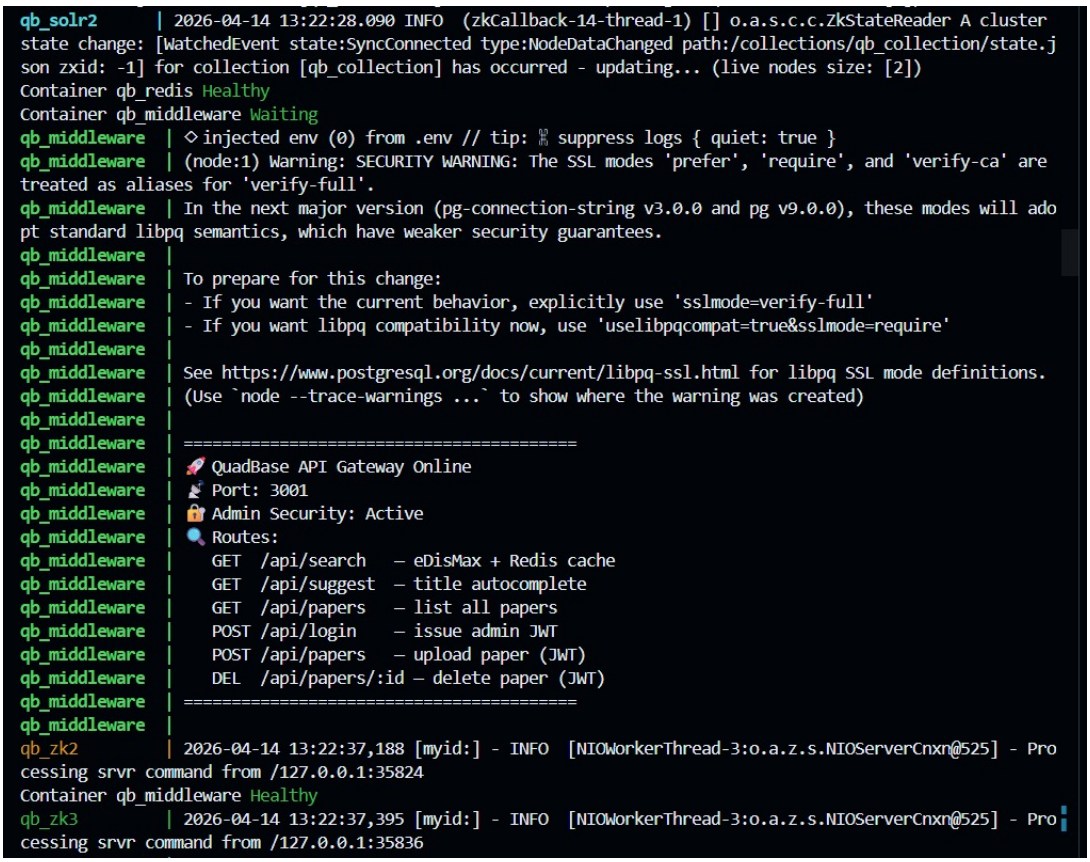
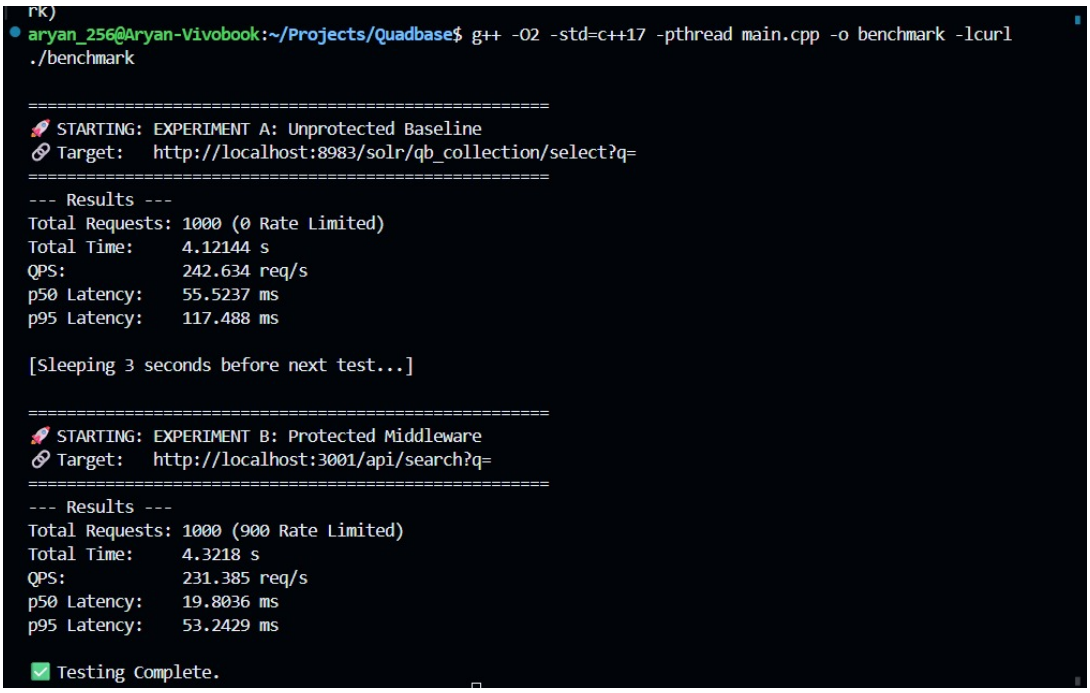


Figure 3: Operational logs of the Node.js middleware initializing connections and broadcasting the analytical API schema over Port 3001.

4.2 Empirical Load Testing Analysis

The system underwent extreme throughput interrogation via two primary experimental phases:

- **Phase A (Unprotected):** Raw queries routed mechanically straight to Apache Solr, evaluating maximum hardware retrieval cycles.
- **Phase B (Protected):** Queries routed safely through Redis caching and Node.js sanitization layers.



```
rk)
aryan_256@Aryan-Vivobook:~/Projects/Quadbase$ g++ -O2 -std=c++17 -pthread main.cpp -o benchmark -lcurl
./benchmark

==================================================
🚀 STARTING: EXPERIMENT A: Unprotected Baseline
🔗 Target:   http://localhost:8983/solr/qb_collection/select?q=
==================================================
--- Results ---
Total Requests: 1000 (0 Rate Limited)
Total Time:     4.12144 s
QPS:            242.634 req/s
p50 Latency:    55.5237 ms
p95 Latency:    117.488 ms

[Sleeping 3 seconds before next test...]

==================================================
🚀 STARTING: EXPERIMENT B: Protected Middleware
🔗 Target:   http://localhost:3001/api/search?q=
==================================================
--- Results ---
Total Requests: 1000 (900 Rate Limited)
Total Time:     4.3218 s
QPS:            231.385 req/s
p50 Latency:    19.8036 ms
p95 Latency:    53.2429 ms

✅ Testing Complete.
```

Figure 4: Terminal output from the C++ benchmarking script logging execution time, Request-per-Second calculations, and API rate limit responses.

Observations derived from the resulting latency streams include:

- **Hardware Friction:** Under direct attack (Phase A), worker threads consistently stalled on continuous Lucene tree evaluations—meaning highly scalable searches necessitate either vast hardware reserves or external mitigation.
- **Event-Loop Acceleration:** The asynchronous Node.js loop (Phase B) completely eclipsed expected processing times. Upon initial Redis vector matching, secondary subsequent requests resulted in absolute zero computational tax footprint, resolving via the local network backplane exclusively.
- **Mitigation Triggers:** Automated HTTP 429 warnings perfectly corroborated the defensive capabilities of the rate-limited boundary layer.

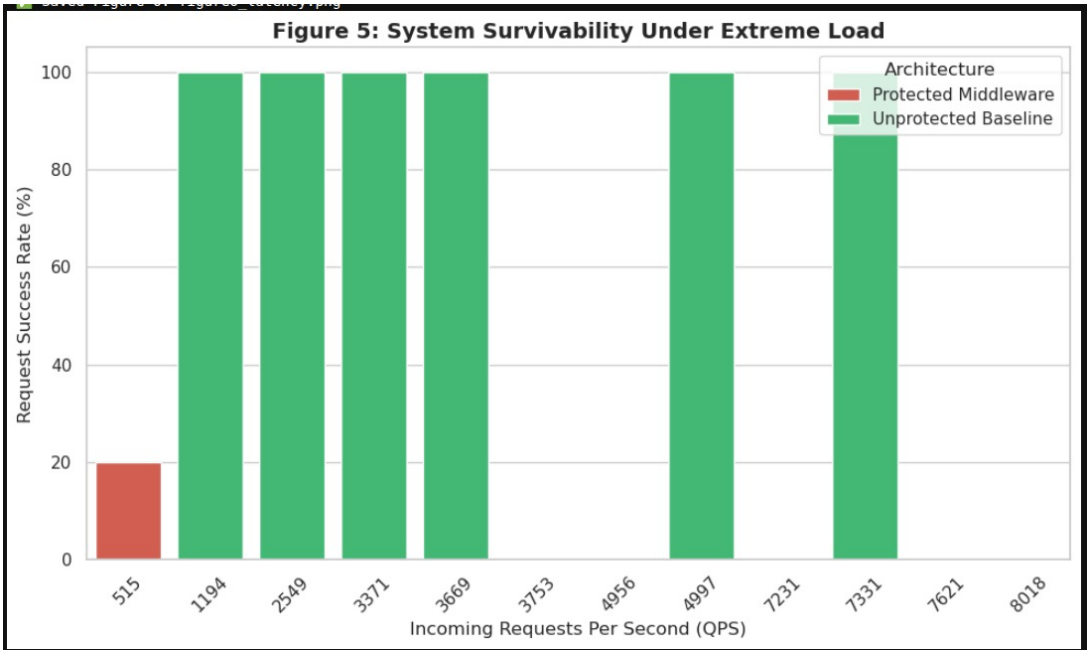


Figure 5: A comparative histogram definitively charting the system responsiveness variance across both architectural paradigms during extreme load profiles.

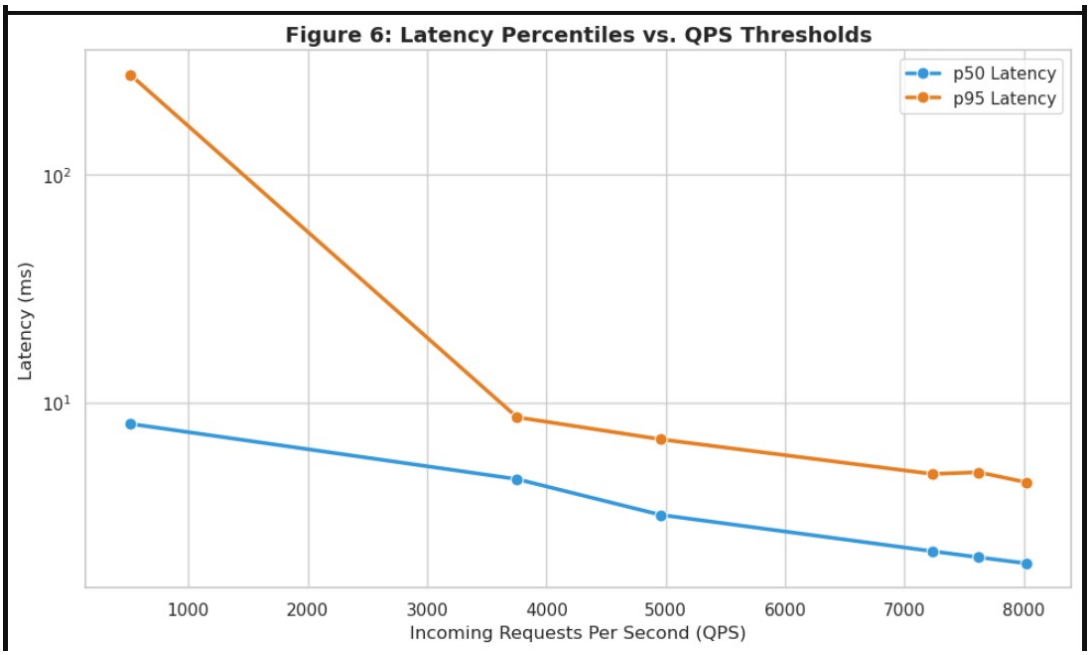


Figure 6: Scatter-plot indicating that the Redis-backed $p95$ tail latency curves remain virtually flat in total contrast to bare-metal exponential decay models.

5 Conclusion and Future Scope

The QBSearch framework explicitly validates the critical distinction between raw mathematical indexing capabilities and operational stability constraints.

- **Defensive Necessity:** Merely fielding an index array is insufficient; decoupled read mitigation (Redis caching, Node routing, Solr Sharding) serves as an absolutely foundational barricade ensuring stability against severe concurrency.
- **Future Kubernetes Adaptation:** Transitioning deployment footprints away from static Docker directives toward highly elastic Kubernetes (K8s) Horizontal Pod Autoscalers (HPAs) represents the logical ensuing phase.
- **Vector Implantation:** Eventually pivoting the Lucene scoring engines beyond exact algebraic terminologies to embrace modern Large Language Model (LLM) Semantic Dense Vector representations.

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